FIRMWARE UPDATE INSTRUCTIONS FOR QLION GOLD CARD

To upgrade the firmware of the QLion Gold card you need a USB Blaster device or a clone of it. Most very cheap usb blaster clones don't work with Windows 10/11 and need windows 7.

I have tested and verified that the not so expensive clone from the following link works in windows 10:

https://www.ebay.com/itm/392480932099

The card has to be powered to be programmed, so this can be done while the card is inserted in the QL. The only "problem" is that the JTAG cable won't allow the card to be inserted with it connected so the QL case has to be opened in this case.

You can also power the card individually out of the QL only if you are certain you know how to do it using the 9V input of the expansion connector.

Below you see how to connect the cable to the X2 JTAG 2x5pin header.

You will need also to install the free quartus programmer software that you can download from the following link:

https://www.altera.com/downloads/fpga-development-tools/quartus-prime-lite-edition-design-software-version-25-1-windows

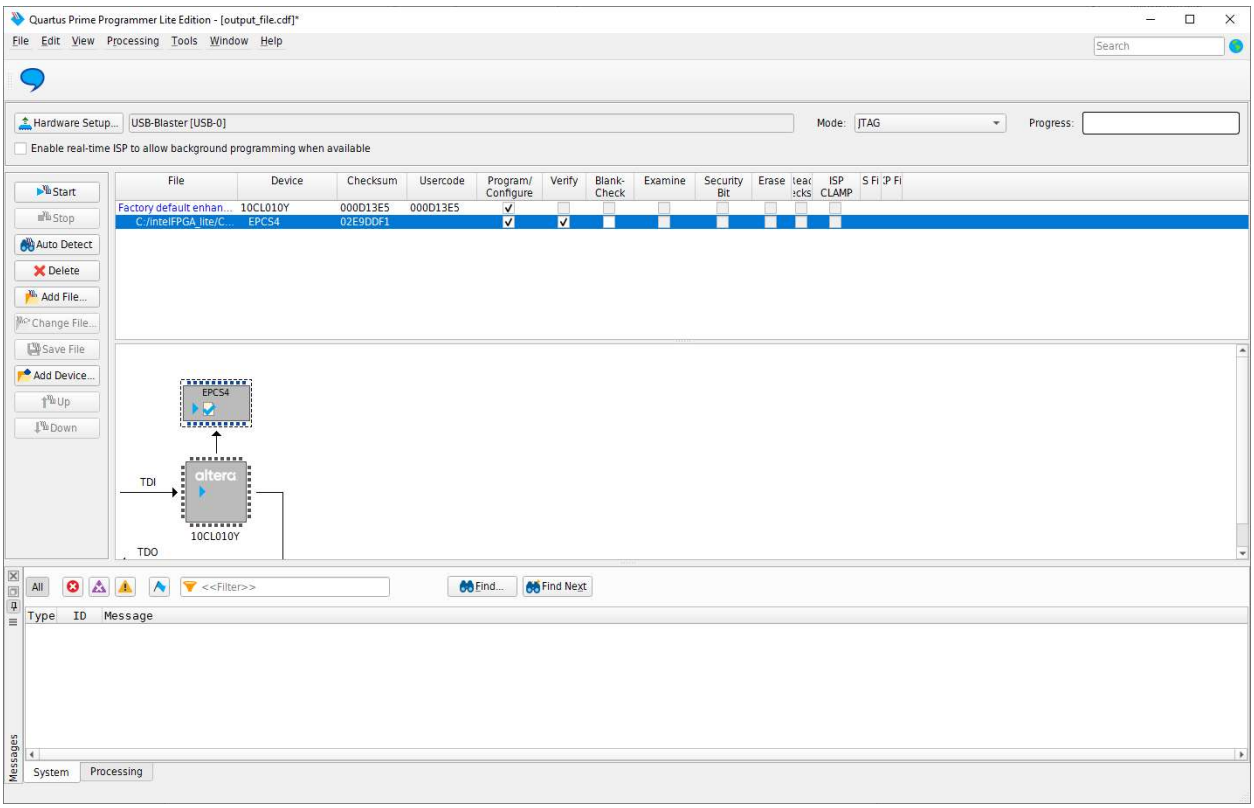
Follow the link and then click the *individual files section* and find the *Quartus Prime Programmer and Tools* and click the download link.

Install the programmer software

Then with the usb blaster connected to the pc and card you start the program, you should see the USB-Blaster next to the Hardware Setup button that means the usb blaster device has been recognized.

Go to File->Open and load the firmware file (.jic)

You must check the Program/Configure and Verify boxes



Power the QL and press Start Button.

When the programming is finished you power down the QL and then power on again and you are ready.